

Kitten Destruction Rehoming Pressure — Action Checklist

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SECURE YOUR HOME

- ☐ **Survey Every Destruction Zone:** Walk through your home and list every surface your kitten has scratched, climbed, or chewed without judgment, because you cannot solve a problem you have not documented and naming the zones takes only 10 minutes.
- ☐ **Remove or Contain High-Risk Items:** Move fragile items to closed rooms, bundle and cover electrical cords with cord covers, research houseplants for toxicity and relocate dangerous ones, and elevate valuables out of reach, because a kitten will investigate everything accessible and prevention costs less than replacement.
- ☐ **Install Alternatives Directly at Each Zone:** Place scratching posts and climbing options within inches of destruction zones instead of across the room, because location is the single most important factor in whether your kitten uses the alternative and she will not walk across the room to scratch.
- ☐ **Apply the 3-Type Scratching Formula:** Install a vertical sisal post next to couch corners for stretching, a horizontal cardboard scratcher near carpet zones for bunny-kicks, and a sturdy cat tree near elevated surfaces for climbing, because each type of scratching serves a different physical and psychological need.

TIRE YOUR KITTEN

- ☐ **Schedule 2-3 Hours of Daily Active Play:** Break your kitten's play requirement into multiple sessions throughout the day totaling 2-3 hours, because unmet energy will be redirected into destruction and there is no option to simply wait it out.
- ☐ **Run 15-20 Minute Interactive Sessions:** Use wand toys and teaser wands to conduct focused play sessions that leave your kitten genuinely tired, not just somewhat entertained, because watching a kitten bat at a toy alone is ambient activity and does not fulfill her biological need to hunt.
- ☐ **Mimic Prey Movement During Play:** Wave wand toys in unpredictable, erratic patterns that simulate wounded prey rather than moving them in straight lines, because kittens hunt instinct and will lose interest quickly without the stimulation of prey-like motion.

- **Track the Energy-Destruction Connection:** Notice when destruction happens and connect it to insufficient play, because your kitten's chaos is not random but directly correlated to energy she has not burned through structured play.

SHIFT YOUR MINDSET

- **Accept That Scratching Is Developmental:** Understand that your kitten scratches to mark territory, stretch her muscles, practice hunting, and relieve stress, because recognizing destruction as learning rather than defiance removes the guilt that makes problem-solving harder.
- **Treat Destruction as an Environment Signal:** Interpret your kitten's behavior as feedback that her environment is not set up for her needs rather than as personal rebellion, because a kitten cannot intentionally hurt you and her actions are always about her own biology.
- **Reject Bitter Apple Spray Solutions:** Do not suppress scratching with deterrents without providing alternative outlets, because bitter apple treats the symptom and your kitten will find another surface or become anxious without addressing her core scratching drive.
- **Prioritize Your Own Emotional Regulation:** Give yourself permission to step away and calm down before addressing destruction, because a frustrated reaction will not help your kitten learn and your emotional wellbeing is a prerequisite for effective training.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.